

Chapter 141_2 - Qiu'er

The door was opened, and the cold wind from outside blew away her sweat. Ning Fuyi looked up in a daze and saw Chu Qingqiu.

She immediately felt weak in the knees, leaning against the wall as she put away the Divine-Demon Manual.

"I sensed your qi was unstable," Chu Qingqiu hurried over, her cold hand touching Ning Fuyi's forehead with worry. "What's wrong with you?"

Ning Fuyi didn't speak, only shook her head, then used her face to find Chu Qingqiu's palm, pressing her cheek against it.

"Chu Qingqiu..." she murmured, "Chu Qingqiu..."

"I don't want you to die," she said. "I want to grow old with you, I want to go to many places with you, do many things. I haven't fulfilled any of those wishes."

"I've loved you for so long, yet we've barely had a few days truly together. How hateful!" Hot tears flowed from her eyes. "I've already fulfilled your great path once—why must there be a second time?"

"I really don't accept it, I won't accept it!" She wiped her tears with her hand, like a reckless child. "What wrong have I done? What wrong have you done?"

"I said I would protect you..." she sobbed.

"Yiyi," Chu Qingqiu's eyes were full of heartache as she embraced Ning Fuyi, gently patting her back.

"Mortal affairs cannot be summed up by right and wrong alone," she said, also containing tears, repeatedly stroking the woman's trembling back.

"Without you, how withered and barren would my life be? I was born from heaven and earth, and I die for heaven and earth—this is my entire life," she said softly. "You've already let me experience human warmth, even made me truly human for a lifetime. I have no regrets."

"Be good, Yiyi. In the future, without Chu Qingqiu, there's simply no more Chu Qingqiu. You still have many people who love you. You won't become a demon again. Isn't this what you wanted most in your previous life—to be free and unrestrained?"

"Without you, what freedom is there?" Ning Fuyi said. "Tomorrow I'll storm Penglai..."

"You know that's impossible," Chu Qingqiu interrupted her, wiping away the hot tears beneath her eyes.

"Emperor Tianrui possesses True God cultivation. If he's truly possessed by an evil spirit, then True God cultivation plus evil spirit power—even if I from a thousand years ago controlled the Crescent Moon Formation, it couldn't be destroyed. Only if the immortal sects unite would there be a chance for battle."

"Moreover, he now has Infinite Ghost Fire. If the ghost fire isn't extinguished, how can you approach Penglai?" Chu Qingqiu's thoughts were clear as she broke down Ning Fuyi's defenses word by word.

Chu Qingqiu watched the light in Ning Fuyi's eyes gradually fade until only emptiness remained, and she too felt extremely sad.

"Yiyi," she said gently, lowering her head to capture her tear-filled lips in an extremely tender kiss.

She took the initiative to explore deeper, actively embracing Ning Fuyi, actively placing Ning Fuyi's hands around her waist, using a tenderness she'd never had in two lifetimes to try to stop her tears.

Even though unaccustomed, even though shy, she still drew her to the table's edge, half-leaning against it.

Using misty peach blossom eyes to look at her, she raised her hand to brush aside her black hair, revealing her reddened neck, grasping her waist sash to pull her into her embrace, indicating for her to raise her hands.

Ning Fuyi followed her guidance, raising her hands to untie the knots on her garments. The flame tips trembled slightly, and the person before her shivered momentarily before being pushed onto the black table.

The tea on the table was knocked over, thick tea dripping steadily to the floor, dampening Chu Qingqiu's hem.

"Yiyi, can you call me something different?" Chu Qingqiu said like a breath, her fingertips tracing over Ning Fuyi's shoulder, grasping her hand to slowly guide it.

"You've only ever called me Divine Venerable," Chu Qingqiu's voice was like a breeze, cool and clear, stirring the heart. She smiled sadly, "I don't want to be the Divine Venerable anymore."

"What would you like to hear?" Ning Fuyi asked through tearful eyes, kissing from her forehead to her nose tip, then sliding across her chin.

"Anything is fine, as long as no one else has called me by it," she said.

"Little Chu," Ning Fuyi looked up, but her hands didn't stop, watching the snow-white skin gradually take on deeper colors.

"Doesn't sound good," Chu Qingqiu shook her head.

"Qingqiu, Qiuqiu, Qiu'er..."

"As you wish," Chu Qingqiu said, opening her arms to embrace Ning Fuyi's neck, biting hard on her earlobe like revenge for her actions.

Ning Fuyi was accustomed to honorific titles. Now changing to calling her by name felt unreal, like insubordination, so she called out several more times.

"Qiu'er, Qiu'er..."

"Yiyi," Chu Qingqiu interrupted her murmuring, saying in her ear, "If there's another life, let me follow you instead."

Let me become a grain of dust on the ground, rising with you, moving toward you.

Ning Fuyi tossed and turned all night, never once releasing Chu Qingqiu's body—either grasping her wrists or holding her waist.

She didn't want to let go, as if only by becoming one with Chu Qingqiu, making her lose her composure, would the other not release her hand.

In the end, when both were exhausted and drowsily letting their immortal energy dissipate, she still used her last bit of strength to pull the person into her embrace, holding her like an octopus.

"Sleep," she said softly, kissing away the satisfied tears that seeped from the corners of her peach blossom eyes.

After that day, Ning Fuyi no longer engaged in such childish imprisonment. Instead, she transformed into a pouch at Chu Qingqiu's waist, or any kind of ornament, constantly grasping her sleeves, staying inseparably close.

In this form, she returned with her to Cloud Ascension Mountain Gate to listen to Elder Pingyao describe the situation of recent days.

Elder Pingyao had exhausted all her lifelong composure not to look at Ning Fuyi clinging to Chu Qingqiu's back like a cloak.

"Sect Leader Tang sent people to Penglai for negotiations, but who would have thought Penglai would release fire, burning several disciples to ash. This matter has shaken the entire immortal realm and even the Six Realms. Now all parties are indignantly clamoring to jointly resist Penglai."

"It seems this matter is more complex—they truly want to destroy all living beings," Elder Pingyao sighed with regret, then looked up, her heart disturbed to the point of unbearable frustration.

"Ning Fuyi, could you please stop clinging to the Divine Venerable?"

"Let her be," Chu Qingqiu said, standing with her hands behind her back.